

Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO)

Area of Interest (Aoi)

Federal Agency: Army

Program Office: Army Contracting Command - Red River Army

Depot CSO Aoi Number: 007

Aoi Release Date: 15 Jan 2026

Responses: See W911RQ-26-S-C001 for Procedure Details

AOI Title: Organic Industrial Base (OIB) Advanced Manufacturing Acceleration at Red River Army Depot (RRAD) — Domestic Component Manufacturing + OIB- Sited Scalable Production

Statutory Anchor: FY26 NDAA, Section 348 Pilot Program of Army Depot and Arsenal Workload Sustainment and Section 351 Modernization of the Organic Industrial Base of the Army

1. Problem / Need Statement

Section 348 of the FY26 NDAA directs the Army to establish your pilot program for work loading the army depots and arsenals. Under the pilot program the secretary shall provide preference to procurements and solicitations by non-government entities to provide sustainment operations for the Army. Section 351 directs the Army to accelerate modernization of its organic industrial base to increase domestic production of critical materials. This initiative targets key areas like propellants, precursor chemicals, and ammunition to reduce supply chain vulnerabilities and meet mission requirements. The Secretary of the Army can also certify other necessary capabilities to Congress.

2. Scope of Solutions Sought

Submitters provide commercially viable advanced manufacturing solutions with the ability to scale, leveraging advanced and/or traditional manufacturing for one or more of the following focus areas:

2.1 Component Categories

- Propellants and precursor materials
- Materials identified without present solutions in DPA Title 3 Call Letters
- Energetics for 2nd source redundancy
- Flexible manufacturing and maintenance systems that afford the Army to easily integrate variations and modular technologies
- Batteries, sensors, chips

2.1a Small-Unmanned Aerial Systems (sUAS) Components (Groups 1-3):

- Brushless motors and motor controllers/ESCs
- Batteries and power systems (cells, packs, BMS, chargers)
- Antennae and communications components
- Flight controllers, printed circuit boards (PCBs), and avionics subassemblies

- Wiring harnesses and connectors
- Rotors, blades/propellers, and propulsion hardware
- Chassis/bodies/frames and structural components
- Sensors and navigation components (e.g., EO/IR, GPS/GNSS, inertial, ranging)

2.2 Solution Types

- Domestic advanced manufacturing scale-up (e.g. new lines, additional shifts, second-source qualification, throughput increases)
- Automation plus artificial intelligence (AI) to maximize effectiveness and pivot to advanced manufacturing
- Secure-by-design supply chain and traceability (material provenance, anti-tamper, firmware integrity)
- Design-for-manufacture and modularization to enable multi-vendor production and reduce lock-in
- Qualification and acceptance improvements that accelerate production while maintaining safety and performance
- OIB-sited production concepts (GOGO/GOCO) that can operate on an OIB installation such as RRAD
- Loan-based partnerships, via the Office of Strategic Capital (OSC), to fund the construction of manufacturing facilities at OIB sites
- Investment-based partnerships leveraging private sector expertise in financial efficiency driven by private sector investments from financial institutions, private equity, and private capital

3. Desired Outcomes

Submissions should quantify expected impacts, including at minimum:

- Manufacturing equipment, automation, and tools that can support modernized manufacturing
- Capacity expansion (e.g. units/month, lead time reduction, yield/first-pass yield improvements)
- Domestic content and supplier diversification (e.g. second-source plans, bill-of-material risk reduction)
- Cost curve (e.g. unit cost at pilot and at scale; learning curve assumptions)
- Time-to-field (e.g. prototype-to-pilot-to-production schedule with milestones)
- No export control issues – neither end-user-certificates (EUCs) nor U.S.-based end-use constraints exist in the proposed solution

4. Pilot / Demonstration Expectations

Submitters should describe a 12–18 month demonstration that produces tangible deliverables, such as:

- Pilot production of components or subassemblies
- Manufacturing process validation data (e.g. yield, test coverage, quality metrics)
- Acceptance and qualification artifacts enabling repeatable government acceptance and second-source expansion
- Transition plan to scaled manufacturing
- Compliance with 10 U.S.C. 4401: Requirement for modular open systems approach (MOSA)

5. OIB Integration

To align with Section 351 partnership models, submissions may include an OIB-sited execution option.

Submitters may propose either (or both) of the following:

- GOCO: the government provides facilities and/or improvements, and the contractor operates the line
- GOGO: where the government provides facilities and/or improvement, and government personnel operate the line.
- Extended Use Land agreements
- Public Private Partnerships

Submissions should describe footprint, utilities, security needs, staffing, EHS considerations, and how the approach avoids vendor lock-in (e.g. multi-tenant/multi-vendor compatible).

6. Submission Content

Submissions should be no longer than 20 pages (12pt font, single spaced) and should include:

- Problem statement fit (which component category; why it is fragile, non-U.S., or single-source)
- Technical approach and maturity (TRL/MRL, key risks, mitigations)
- Manufacturing / industrialization plan (equipment, QA, test approach, scalability)
- Supply chain plan (domestic suppliers, traceability, cybersecurity/firmware assurance)
- Schedule with milestones (0–90 days, 6 months, 12–18 months)
- Cost and private investment leverage plan (cost share, CAPEX, non-federal funding)
- Transition plan (path to sustained production and competitive procurement)
- Additional considerations addressed by the solution that are not listed above

7. Evaluation Factors

The Government may evaluate submissions using factors such as:

- Technical merit and feasibility (innovation + manufacturability)
- Industrial base impact (fragility reduction, domestic supplier expansion, second-source viability)
- Speed and scalability (time-to-pilot, time-to-scale, throughput)
- Price (proposed price is fair and reasonable)
- Private investment leverage (extent practicable)
- Transition plan (credible path to production/procurement without harming the commercial sUAS base)

8. Notes for Submitters

- Submissions should clearly distinguish what is already commercially available versus what requires further development.
- Submissions should identify any foreign dependencies and propose mitigation plans and alternate sourcing.
- Submissions utilizing OIB resources will remain competitive.
- Submissions should address how the solution will remain compliant with existing export controls.
- Submissions must analyze all data rights issues—including for technical data, software, and intellectual property—and their impact on competitive sourcing, vendor lock-in, and

industrial base options.

- A written solution brief must be sent via e-mail submission by 5:00 P.M. (CDT) on 29 Jan 2026, with the subject line stating SOLUTION for Organic Industrial Base (OIB) Advanced Manufacturing Acceleration at Red River Army Depot (RRAD) — Domestic Component Manufacturing + OIB- Sited Scalable Production AoI A007 to: usarmy.rrad.acc.mbx.cso@army.mil.
- Solution briefs must conform to the requirements outlined in Section 3 of the master CSO solicitation W911RQ-26-S-C001.
- Point of Contacts:
 - Contracting Officer: christopher.l.johnston20.civ@army.mil
 - CSO/AoI POC: jacob.j.horn.civ@army.mil

Reference: FY26 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA), Section 348 & 351.